

Lecture 05 — Linear and affine functions

Wed Sep 2

Last updated: August 18, 2026.

The class outline for this day will be posted before class.

Related reading and the course-wide list of daily objectives: [Lectures](#).

Learning objectives

By the end of class, students should be able to:

1. Distinguish linear from affine functions in examples.
2. Test superposition numerically on simple functions.
3. Construct a function $a^\top x + b$ for a contextual quantity.
4. Evaluate a model by hand and computationally.